THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Because forts were located on hills, the Mughal cavalry 1

(a) rode inside **(b)** easily won

(c) struggled to use its strength **(d)** needed no horses

2. The expression 'Hindavi Swarajya' implies 1

(a) empire of Persians **(b)** theocracy

(c) a kingdom of the people of the land **(d)** foreign colony

3. A ruler uses a Sanskrit seal and local language instead of Persian. This shows 1

(a) foreign rule **(b)** no interest

(c) cultural assertion **(d)** trade

4. The Treaty of Purandar can be seen as 1

(a) complete defeat **(b)** end of Marathas

(c) a tactical retreat **(d)** victory

5. Shivaji's policy of sending officials to different posts at intervals ensures 1

(a) accountability **(b)** power gain **(c)** corruption **(d)** friendship

6. Chauth collected from lands outside direct rule could cause 1

(a) resentment among those paying **(b)** an end of war

(c) no change **(d)** joy among all

7. If the state allows free passage for a tax of 25%, this resembles 1

(a) zakat **(b)** iqta **(c)** jizya **(d)** chauth

8. A merchant ship from Surat is attacked. This suits which event? 1

(a) Sack of Surat by Shivaji **(b)** Panipat

(c) Purandar **(d)** Agra visit

9. **Assertion (A):** The Third Battle of Panipat (1761) was fought between the Marathas and Ahmad Shah Abdali. 1

Reason (R): The Marathas won a decisive victory at Panipat.

Choose the correct option:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.

(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.

(c) A is true but R is false.

(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Kabir was a saint of Maharashtra's bhakti tradition. 1
Reason (R): Maharashtra's bhakti saints wrote in Marathi, the language of the people.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did chauth increase Maratha influence? 2

12. How did disunity harm the Marathas? 2

13. Why might salaried officials be better than landholding officials for a ruler? 2

14. Why was Aurangzeb unable to end Maratha resistance? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the Maratha guerrilla tactics against a larger Mughal army. 3

16. Examine how language and script reflect Maratha identity. 3

17. Compare Tarabai's and Ahilyabai's types of leadership. 3

OR

Source: 'We shall not take away mango or jackfruit trees.' Explain what this shows about the ruler. 3

18. Compare the Maratha and Mughal army structures. 3

OR

Analyse the effect of the Anglo-Maratha wars on India's politics. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In 1665, under pressure from the Mughal commander Jai Singh, Shivaji signed the Treaty of Purandar and gave up a part of his forts. Later he visited Aurangzeb's court at Agra, was placed under house arrest, and escaped by hiding in baskets of gifts. He recovered his forts and was crowned at Raigad in 1674. 5
(i) Name the treaty signed in 1665.
(ii) How did Shivaji escape from Agra?
(iii) What title did he take at Raigad?
(iv) What does this episode show about his strategy?

20. Discuss the strengths and weaknesses of the Maratha confederacy. 5

OR

Evaluate the impact of the Marathas on India's political and cultural map. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks